



Inspiring Excellence

Final Assignment

PREPARED BY	Md. Tanvir Ahmed Tonmoy
STUDENT ID	22221028
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TASK 01

The Inner Audit: Self-Care in Practice

1.1 Self-care baseline

To begin with, my self care scores were quite scattered all around. However, it was pretty much what I expected it to be. My social self care was the best out of all the domains, at 13/15, while emotional self care was the lowest at 5/15. As I mentioned before, I had already expected this as I usually deal with stress by keeping myself busy rather than sitting with the feeling itself. Sometimes I do talk to people regarding my problems but mindfulness and journaling are totally absent from my routine. All of these made it pretty obvious that emotional self care is the main domain I should be working on.

Domain	Score / 15
Physical Self-Care	7
Emotional Self-Care	5
Mental Self-Care	10
Social Self-Care	13
Spiritual Self-Care	6

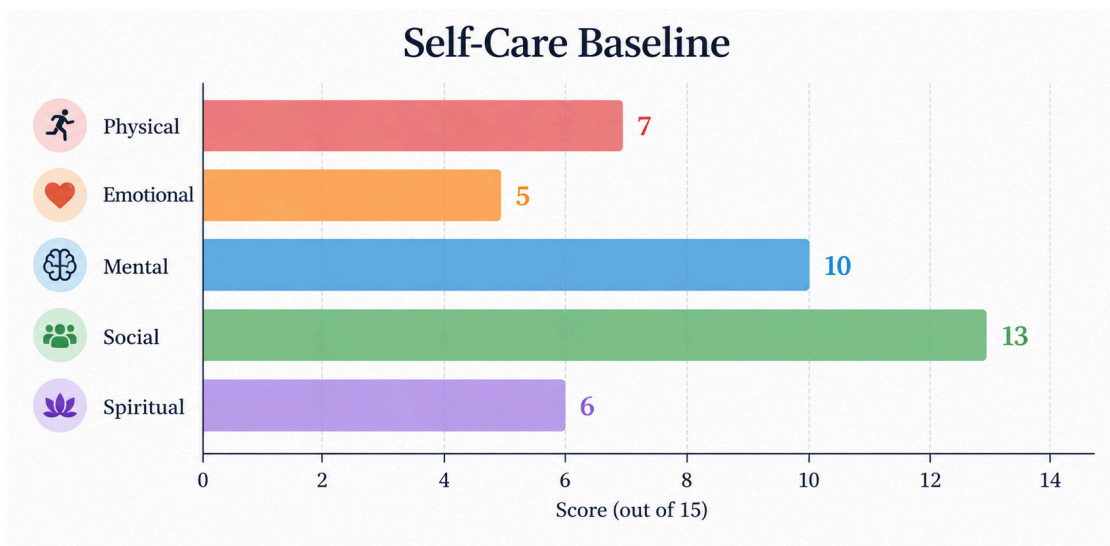


Figure 1. Self care scores.

Category	Statement	1	2	3	4	5
Physical Self-Care	I exercise regularly.		✓			
	I eat a balanced and nutritious diet.			✓		
	I get enough sleep each night.		✓			
Emotional Self-Care	I practice mindfulness or meditation.	✓				
	I journal my thoughts and feelings.	✓				
	I talk to someone when I need emotional support.			✓		
Mental Self-Care	I read books or engage in activities that stimulate my mind.		✓			
	I take breaks and rest when needed.				✓	
	I learn new skills or hobbies.				✓	
Social Self-Care	I spend quality time with family and friends.					✓
	I participate in social activities or groups.				✓	
	I set and maintain healthy boundaries in my relationships.				✓	
Spiritual Self-Care	I engage in practices that connect me to my inner self.		✓			
	I spend time in nature or other calming environments.	✓				
	I reflect on my values and beliefs regularly.			✓		

Figure 2. Self care quiz table.

1.2 Five days of emotional self-care

Date	What happened
7 September 2026	I talked to a close friend of mine regarding my graduation this semester. I also shared about the piling up of adult responsibilities. It feels like all of a sudden all the eyes are towards me and this pressure is unbearable. The main fear I had was the fear of unemployment and whether I would find a job. Saying it aloud made my chest a bit lighter than before.
8 September 2026	After feeling a bit better I went on and talked about the same topic with a different group of friends. I found out that it was not only me that was feeling this way. Almost all of my friends were feeling some level of uncertainty regarding graduation.
9 September 2026	It was not possible for me to continue this activity because I had a job interview. I was preparing for that so all of my attention went there.
10 September 2026	I talked to the first friend again but this time regarding the solutions of this anxiety. It was a pretty fruitful session I would say because we did figure out some ideas regarding the solutions such as applying more widely and keeping options open towards multiple disciplines.

Date	What happened
11 September 2026	The interview result had still not been published and the uncertainty brought the stress back. I vented my frustration to my friend; it did not solve the uncertainty, but I did not have to carry it alone.

1.3 One difficult moment, worked through

Stressful moment: preparing for the job interview while carrying a larger fear of unemployment after graduation.

ABCD step	My completed worksheet
A - Activating event	Preparing for a job interview while graduation is approaching.
B - Belief / thought	“What if I cannot get a job after graduating?” One interview started to feel connected to my whole future.
C - Consequence	Anxiety, repetitive thinking and difficulty sleeping. I study more at night to exhaust myself enough to fall asleep.
D - Dispute / balanced response	I can control preparation, applications and skill development. I cannot control the publication time of the result or guarantee an employer’s decision. One interview is evidence about one opportunity, not my entire future.

Worksheet 1. ABCD model completed for the interview-related stress.

From the worksheet it became very clear that the interview was not the centre point of my stress. The stronger part was the feeling lingering behind “What if I cannot get a job after graduation?” Once it appeared, everything felt like a boulder of emotions that I was not yet ready to process. Because of this I get really anxious and have difficulty sleeping. The main defence mechanism of this is to study till late hours so that my body becomes too tired to think and I could get a little sleep from that. Otherwise the thoughts would just return as soon as I lay down on my bed.

The difference between distress and dysfunction is subtle. Distress can be real without automatically becoming a psychological disorder whereas dysfunction means the pattern is severe enough to interfere with everyday life. In my case, my fear and anxiety did affect my mood and my sleep; however, I was still preparing for my everyday life. I still get up from bed every morning with a little bit of hope that everything will be fine. The worksheet also pointed towards a control problem. I can control my preparations and skill development, however, I cannot control when a result is published or an

employer's decision. Communicating with others regarding my issues helped me separate the parts on which I can act on and on which I cannot.

TASK 02

The Exposure: One Real Setting — Track B

2.1 Being there



Figure 3. Roadside tea stall beside BRAC University, 7 September 2026, around 5:00 PM.

The roadside tea stall beside BRAC University was visited by me on 7th September at around 5 pm. It was a pretty busy place. Most of the customers were students from the university. They were chatting, drinking tea, gossiping and then left after finishing their tea. I went to that stall many times but never really observed people or the surroundings like this before. I had assumed that people would sit for much longer but I think because of classes and other activities they could not stay for long. Even though they did not stay for long, that place still felt familiar and social.

2.2 One real conversation

I tried to have a conversation with the tea stall owner. I am going to just call him “Mama” for privacy reasons. He is in his mid thirties and he has worked at the stall for 14 years. I have known Mama for 3 years now, right from the early days when the campus shifted to Badda. He took over this stall after his father had a leg injury and now his younger brother also has his own stall nearby.

He sold his old tea shop to renovate his house in his hometown. Because of this he had to relocate to a roadside stall. Mama said, “After moving my shop, my sales dropped around 30-40%.” He also mentioned that, “The old customers still come even though the shop is smaller now.” His strongest line was, “As long as I don’t betray the customers, the customers won’t betray me as well.” The conversation was in Bangla and it was translated to English for the sake of this assignment.

2.3 Comparing the tea stall setting with Keyes’ framework

Dimension	Score	Observation-based justification
Social Integration	4/5	Regular customers keep returning, and Mama’s long relationship with them gives the stall a clear sense of belonging.
Social Acceptance	4/5	His explanation of loyalty is based on trust, reciprocity and a positive view of the customers he has served for years.
Social Contribution	4/5	The stall serves students every day and also becomes a small social contact point around the university.
Social Actualization	3/5	He has adapted after losing the old shop, but I did not hear enough to claim a strong belief about wider social progress.
Social Coherence	2/5	This appears most damaged: the move made the business less predictable and he reports a 30–40% fall in sales.

Table 1. Keyes’s five dimensions of social wellbeing applied in the tea stall setting.

Keyes' Framework Score Overview

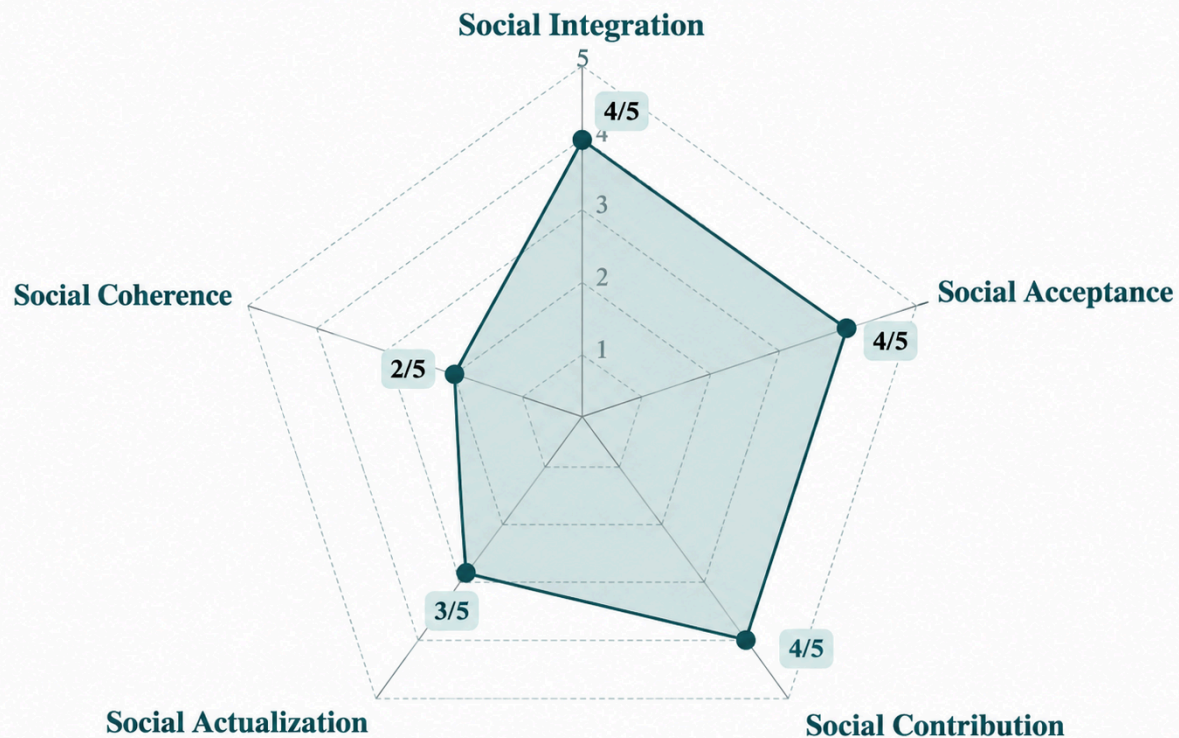


Figure 4: Visual Representation of Keyes's Framework Scores for the Tea Stall Setting

The weakest dimension after comparing appears to be social coherence. The shift from a full fledged tea shop to a simple roadside tea stall made the economic state less predictable. This connects very well with the WHO idea of Quality of Life. It includes a person's own position in life in relation to goals, expectations and environment. Even though his economic state was getting weaker, the social relationship he has built over the years stayed stronger. Quality of life therefore cannot be read from money alone.

TASK 03

The Contribution: Three Days of Doing Something

3.1 Three-day log

Date and time	What I actually did
7 September 2026, around 5:00 PM	I casually went up to mama and jokingly said, "Mama, I will be your intern for 3 days." He seemed very happy that I wanted to spend time on his side of the stall. I watched how he handled orders and kept track of transactions.

Date and time	What I actually did
8 September 2026, around 6:00 PM	Instead of just sitting beside mama, I tried to learn some of the basics of tea making when there were no customers. I realised that something that I get readily had years of experience blended in it.
9 September 2026, around 8:00 PM	I tried making a cup of tea and served it to a friend. My friend said it was awful, which became the joke of the evening. Mama found it funny too, and it reminded me that fourteen years of experience cannot be copied in three days. I also heard students discussing university problems, relationships and everyday frustrations.

3.2 What it did to me

These three days changed the interaction from a normal customer–seller relationship into something more participatory. The first social skill I had to stretch was initiation. I already knew Mama, but saying that I wanted to stay, observe and learn from him still felt slightly unusual because our normal interaction is short and transactional. The social-skills lecture describes social skills as the ability to communicate and interact effectively, and its scale includes self-expression and initiating interactions. I had to use both.

The Keyes dimension that became most visible in me was social contribution. To be fair, I did not contribute in any large sense. However, I stopped treating the stall as a mere service that I consumed. Rather, I started to give attention and genuine interest back to someone who had served me for years. This change might be small but it did make me feel more connected to that place than ever before.

Another improvement I noticed was my subjective happiness. However, this improvement felt more eudaimonic than hedonic. Joking around with mama and my friends was fine but the more stronger part was having an understanding of his work and seeing a familiar place with a different perspective. One thing that contradicted my expectations was how little time customers spend there. I used to think a tea stall was a place for long gossip sessions. However, most likely due to the customers being students mostly this was not true for that place. This helped me understand that even with short repeated visits, strong connections can be made.

3.3 The honest limit

Even if every student in my section spent time with a tea stall worker, the seller-customer relationship might improve but the economic problem underneath Mama’s situation would still remain the same. Friendly customers cannot give me back his old shop or cannot reverse his loss in sales. A personal wellbeing action can increase respect and social connection but it does not create commercial

security. This is the limit I hit during my 3 days. I could make the relationship between me and Mama less transactional however, I could not restore the financial situation he was in.

TASK 04

The Wrap: Semester Reflection and a Letter Forward

4.1 Three concepts that moved

Concept	Where it came from	How it moved in my life
Hedonic vs. eudaimonic wellbeing	Pre-midterm wellbeing lecture	In the beginning I thought that wellbeing is mostly related to feeling relaxed and comfortable. My midterm observation changed that point of view. During that observation my highest mood point was during a meaningful project that I was doing. Because of this, eudaimonic wellbeing is much more personal to me. I still value rest but I now understand why doing something meaningful would lift up my mood.
Keyes' social wellbeing	Lecture 6: Social Well-being	At first, I treated the five dimensions as another topic to memorize. However, spending more time at the tea stall made integration much easier to understand. I understood that belonging can be built through repeated small interactions as well, not just close friendship or organised communities. It became clear that a place can be socially meaningful even when people pass through it quickly.
Distress versus dysfunction	Psychological Disorders and Therapy	Before this lecture, I had always categorized my intense stress without even realizing what was actually going on. Preparing for the interview actually helped me find a more useful distinction. The fear of unemployment that I had was real enough to keep me awake at night but it was not stopping me from preparing for the next day. I was still functional. Even though I was losing sleep and it is not something I should ignore but I now could carefully analyze what was going on and categorize it accordingly.

4.2 A letter to my future self

13 September 2026

Dear future me,

Do you remember how uncertain this semester felt? Graduation was knocking on the door and the question of whether I would find a job was strong enough to keep me awake all night. However, this course has taught me that wellbeing is not just about feeling good, it is also about the work I do, how I recover and connect with others.

After a year, I want my sleep to be less dependent on my anxiety. There will always be anxiety in all stages of life but I hope that I was able to understand that not everything is under our control. Sometimes we just have to go with the flow. I also do hope that after a year I will still be able to feel happiness from doing meaningful things.

Regarding collective wellbeing, I just do not want everyday relationships to become completely transactional. I should get to know the people around me more and sometimes maybe stand on their side of the counter.

I just want you to check some things. Am I sleeping better? Do I still call a friend when the pressure becomes too much to handle all by myself? Am I still doing meaningful things without letting it consume all of my time? And last but not least, do I still stop and talk to people like Mama?

If not, this letter is simply a reminder to readjust again.

— Tonmoy

Approximate word count: 1936

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